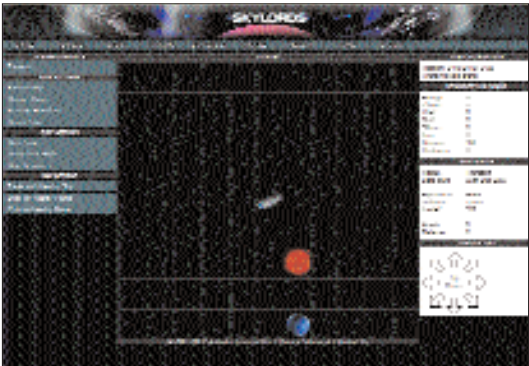
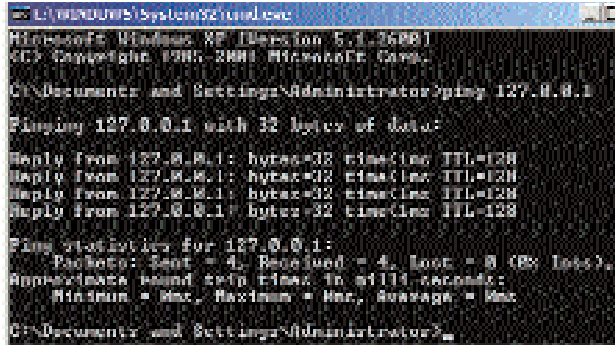




Thousands of people play the browser-based multi-player strategy game SkyLords

Before joining a server, make sure to ping it to see whether it's worth joining. Go to **Start > Run**, type '**command**' and press [Enter]. Ping the game server by typing '**ping <IP>**' or '**ping <URL>**' depending on whether the server you have is in IP or URL format.



You can ping yourself by typing 'ping 127.0.0.1' or 'ping local host'

The average value is what you should look at, the lower it is, the closer or faster the server is. An average of 300 ms or more is bad, and you definitely don't want to be on such a server. Also remember that data loss should be as close to 0 per cent as possible. For India, games servers located in the US are just too far away; instead look for servers in Singapore, or within India itself.

There are three different ways to find the server that is nearest to you. The first is to use the in-game browsers. Many games, such as Halo, Call of Duty, IGI2, etc., have in-built browsers to find the servers. Normally, to access these, you have to go to your game's **Multiplayer > Internet** menu option.

Here you're presented with a list of available game servers, the number of users, ping times and other information. Arrange the list in ascending order by clicking on the 'ping' tab, and join the server with the lowest ping time.

Another method is to use third-party game-server browsers. These

browsers are like the in-game browsers, except that they support many games. One of the most popular browsers is Game Spy Arcade—download it from www.gamespyarcade.com. Not only can you find servers for most games, you can also use the inbuilt Web browser for some browser based fun.

Qtracker (www.qtracker.com) is a server browser with additional functionalities such as LAN game server browser, server



Use your in-game browser to find the game server with lowest ping

launcher, MP3 streaming audio browser, HTM server list generator, etc. It keeps track of where a particular player is playing, and shows you an image of the map the player is playing on. You can change skins, and also search within Asia for a game server—thus providing you with faster servers.

Another game server browser called aGSM (www.agsm.net), allows you to find

What's Out There				
	Web site	URL	Pros	Cons
Browser-based games	Yahoo! Games	http://games.yahoo.com	Addictive and easy to learn games.	Many games are not free
	MSN Gaming Zone	www.zone.com	Clearly demarcated section for Free games	You may need to install some software to play certain games. Most games are large, and take time to load
	Miniclip	www.miniclip.com	A lot of unique games	Demo versions can only be played for 15 minutes a day
	SkyLords	www.skylords.com	Interesting MMOG game with many interesting features such as diplomacy, trading, piracy, espionage, space battles, custom space-ship model designing and clan warfare	Not everyone likes MMOGs
Game browsers	Game Spy Arcade	www.gamespyarcade.com	Has a huge number of supported games. You can also play browser-based games	None
	Qtracker	www.qtracker.com	Can search for LAN games. In-built MP3 streaming audio browser can generate HTML server list	Doesn't support as many games as Game Spy Arcade
Indian servers	Frag-shak	www.frag-shack.com	Servers in Mumbai	Paid service; doesn't support many games
	Kawabonka	www.kawabonka.com	Free servers in Delhi	Doesn't support many games